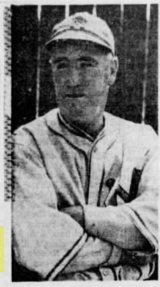
Newspapers by ancestry
https://www.newspapers.com/image/202715389/

Millers Open Tonight; Obtain Schmidt From New York

WHEN THESE INDIANS WERE MILLERS



HERE'S Donie Bush, now president of the Indianapolis Indians, as he looked when he managed the Millers, 1932-39.

ANDY COHEN, right, had many exciting days while playing for Minneapolis in 1938 when Ted Williams, now of the Boston Red Sox, also was a member of the Millers. Cohen currently is manager of the Indianapolis Indians.

By TOM BRIERE
Minneapolis Tribune Sports Writer

INDIANAPOLIS, Ind. — On the eve of Minneapolis' 1957 American Association opener against Indianapolis at 7:45 o'clock tonight, the parent New York Giants Monday purchased the contract of catcher Valmy Thomas from the Millers and sent catcher Bob Schmidt on option to Minneapolis.

The 24-year-old Schmidt, who caught for Miller manager Red Davis at Dallas last year and hit .282 with power, will not be able to help the Millers until they return to Metropolitan stadium April 25.

Schmidt has been out for 10 days with an injured right shoulder. He will report in Minneapolis, however, and do some running at the stadium to remain in condition.

"I'M WELL pleased with the addition of Schmidt," Davis said upon arrival here. "I know what Bob can do because he did it all for me last year—good receiver, good arm, smart behind the plate in handling pitchers and dangerous at bat.

"Now if we can get a couple more pitchers and an outfielder, we'll be ready to give 'em all a run."

Schmidt bats righthanded. He stands 6-2 and weighs 190 pounds. A native of St. Louis, big Bob is regarded as the coming young catching prospect in the Giants' system. He'll do the bulk of the Millers receiving with Jake Jenkins for relief.

BOB WAS injured this spring in a collision with pitcher Gordon Jones just when it appeared he might win the No. 1 catching job with New York. Since he was forced into inactivity, Manager Bill Rigney was forced to switch to Wes Westrum and Valmy Thomas to be ready for the National league start today.

Schmidt broke into baseball in 1951 and played with Oshkosh, Wis., in 1952 before spending two years in service. Last year at Dallas in 111 games, Bob had 95 hits, 17 doubles, 13 home runs, and 59 runs batted in.

Tonight, though, little Stu Miller, the Millers' spring training ace righthander, will be pitching to Jenkins against a rookie-laden Indianapolis club managed by ex-Minneapolis second baseman Andy Cohen.

"WE'VE GOT a lot of question marks," said Andy, who played for the Millers in the mid-30s. "We need help to figure in the race."

The Indians will be defending 1956 Association honors with a new team under a working agreement with the Chicago White Sox instead of Cleveland.

Indianapolis received some valuable additions over the week-end in shortstop Jose Valdivielso on option from Washington and pitchers Tom Flanigan and Roger Howard from the White Sox. The Cuban shortstop batted .313 in 23 games with Louisville a year ago.

Cohen is undecided between veteran Al Papai and 20-year-old Barry Latman, both righthanders up from Memphis, but leans to Latman as his opening night hurler.

CATCHER BOB SCHMIDT
Optioned to Minneapolis

Never Looked Better for Hot Twin City Race

CULLUM'S COLUMN
by
DICK CULLUM

A WAY WE GO FOR BASEBALL AGAIN. The outlook was never brighter for fun in the Twin Cities.

St. Paul will play in a brand new stadium and the Minneapolis stadium is still shiney after a break-in year.

It is agreed that both Saints and Millers should be in the race from the outset and strong first division teams through the season.

With expected additional strength, if it comes in time and for the right spots, these two might fight it out for the pennant.

Take all the factors into consideration and this might be the most interesting, successful, profitable, explosive season we have had in Twin Cities baseball in years.

There is a new rivalry building up and it looks as if both sides would have the playing strength to make the rivalry crackle with good baseball.

LOOK AT THOSE TACKLES

NOW AND THEN IN THE PAST THE Minnesota football team has shown tremendous power at the tackles. More than once Minnesota has led the nation in its tackle strength.

The Gophers have been lucky, at times, to have their good tackles come in pairs such as George Hauser and Frank Mayer; Bronko Nagurski and Mike Gary; Ed Widseth and Dick Smith; Dick Wildung and Urban Odson.

Well, such a time may be at hand again. It is doubtful that Minnesota was ever more powerful and, at the same time, deeper at tackle than it will be at the start of spring practice today.

Believe it or not there are two, and may be three tackles who may qualify for all-sectional honors or better.

They pair off this way: Frank Youso and Dave Herbold; Ed Buckingham and Norm Sixta; Mike Wright and Francis Brixius.

TRADES MAKE OR BREAK

AN ILLUSTRATION CAN BE MADE of what the making, or not making, of one trade can do to the fortunes of a team, in this case the Minneapolis Lakers basketball team.

This was in 1956. Vern Mikkelsen was in a slump and was talking of retiring. Nevertheless, Boston, thinking the addition of one big man would win the championship, was willing to take him in trade.

Mikkelsen

Being willing to trade off some of their future for immediate results they offered Cliff Hagan, Lou Tsioropoulos and Frank Ramsey.

Had the deal been made the immediate result would have been to place the Lakers in last place for all three were in service. As it was the Lakers finished only one game out of last place. Had they finished one game lower they would have had draft rights on Bill Russell.

HAGAN ONE OF BEST

SINCE THEN HAGAN HAS BECOME ONE of the best young stars in the league at St. Louis. Second only to Bob Pettit, Hagan was responsible for knocking the Lakers out of the playoff and for nearly upsetting highly favored Boston in the championship round. It was Pettit and Hagan all the way as St. Louis carried Boston to seven games and to two overtimes in the seventh game before losing.

Ramsey, meanwhile, returned from service and, although not in top condition, immediately proved himself another of the better young players. His seven points in one overtime saved Boston in the championship series.

The deal, in efect, would have traded one older player with brief service time remaining for Russell, and the three young Kentucky stars, Hagan, Ramsey and Tsioropoulos.

With Russell in the front line and Hagan and Ramsey bolstering the back court the Lakers and not Boston would be the team of the future.

ORACLES OIL UP EARLY

NATIONAL MAGAZINES WHICH NEXT fall publish ponderously expert forecasts in all matters pertaining to football are already gathering their material although spring practice is just starting in some of the better football centers. Their articles will be written on the basis of the unincubated information now being gathered.

One of them asked this space to rate the Big Ten teams for next fall. Well, if they are foolish enough to accept anyone's guess at this stage we are foolish enough to send it along; but the aside to our regular customers is, "Don't believe a word of it."

It went in this way:
Group 1—Michigan and Michigan State.
Group 2—Minnesota, Ohio State and Iowa.
Group 3—Purdue, Illinois and Northwestern.
Group 4—Wisconsin and Indiana.

. . AND NOW

DONIE BUSH
As an Indian in 1957

ANDY COHEN
How he looks today

IT'S LIKE OLD TIMES

Ex-Millers Bush, Cohen Team Again

By Staff Writer

INDIANAPOLIS, Ind. — The Indianapolis baseball brain trust has a distinct Minneapolis flavor this season in the persons of President Donie Bush and Manager Andy Cohen.

A friendship born in Minneapolis from 1932 to 1939 has blossomed here again this spring, and both Bush, ex-Miller manager, and Cohen, former Miller second-base sparkplug, agree that "It's certainly nice to be back together again."

Bush claimed he saw managerial possibilities in Cohen back in those Miller days at Nicollet park. Donie says Andy always asked a lot of questions.

"Andy was cute as a player, and he's cute as a manager," Bush declared Monday.

"You don't fool Andy easily." I've always liked him because he is sharp on the field and off; Andy can do a tremendous public relations job in selling the game with his wit and polish.

"I've corresponded with Andy ever since our days together in Minneapolis, and always figured that if the opportunity arose, I'd like to have Cohen manage for me."

The opportunity presented itself this year when Indianapolis switched from a Cleveland to a Chicago White Sox working agreement.

"Andy managed at New Orleans last year, and for several years at Denver," Bush continued. "When we needed a skipper, Andy was my man, and the White Sox were perfectly agreeable."

Fast-talking Andy admits he is pleased to be back in the American Association.

"I always enjoyed playing for Donie those seven seasons in Minneapolis," Cohen said, "And I'm sure it will be just as nice managing for him. It will be fun to return to Minneapolis, too.

Incidentally, General Manager Rosy Ryan of the Millers is planning to present Cohen a "welcome home" gift at Metropolitan stadium when the Indians open there April 25, and Rosy also wants to stage a "Cohen day" later in the season.

The Cohen-Bush working agreement sizes up the 1957 Indians: "Not too good, not too bad. Our outfield is weak, we need a good righthanded hitter, and a winning pitcher plus another catcher."

Bush added: "The White Sox have given us all the help they have. You know, they don't have as many players as Cleveland, but I'm sure they'll do what they can for us, and when they send us a player, we know we have him to stay."

The Indians, who are owned by baseball fan stockholders, in much the same manner as the Minneapolis basketball Lakers, report the biggest pre-season ticket sale in history with an advance of 63,000 in the till before the opener tonight. The record was 59,000 set in 1949.

Baltimore Nips Senators 7-6; Rest of Majors Start Today

Minneapolis Morning Tribune
SPORTS SECTION

Openers to Draw Nearly 250,000

By Associated Press

For at least 24 hours Baltimore can sneer at the New York Yankees and the rest of the American league from its first-place perch after beating Washington 7-6 in an 11-inning special opening game before a crowd of 23,872, including President Eisenhower.

If the weather man smiles, about 250,000 more fans will turn out Tuesday in eight major league parks for the first full day of baseball.

The President lobbed two pitches toward a mass of Baltimore and Washington pitchers in the traditional pregame ceremonies. Don Ferrarese of the Orioles caught the first and Neil Chrisley, a sub outfielder for the Senators, grabbed the second.

THEN, THE clubs started to work on the two starting pitchers, Hector Brown of the Orioles and Bob Chakales of the Senators. Neither was around at the finish when the game finally ended in the 11th on Dick Williams' double, a sacrifice bunt by Al Pilarcik and a sacrifice fly by rookie Carl Powis.

Billy Loes, fourth Baltimore pitcher, was the winner over Camilo Pascual who replaced Chakales in the eighth.

Baltimore opened up an early lead but sloppy fielding helped Washington chase Brown in the fourth when they scored five runs. Gus Triandos drove in two runs with a single in the fifth and hit a two-run homer in the seventh to put the Orioles out front only to have Washington tie at 6-6 in the eighth on Clint Courtney's double following a walk to Eddie Yost.

Triandos' smash into the centerfield bleachers at the 380-foot mark was the only homer of the sunny and slightly chilly afternoon.

Everybody gets into the act today with a full eight-game schedule, including a night opener at Philadelphia.

The schedule:

AMERICAN LEAGUE
Washington at New York.
Boston at Baltimore.
Chicago at Cleveland.
Detroit at Kansas City.

NATIONAL LEAGUE
Brooklyn at Philadelphia (night).
Milwaukee at Chicago.
St. Louis at Cincinnati.
New York at Pittsburgh.

(Probable pitchers and estimated attendance in Standings elsewhere this page.)

MICKEY MANTLE, who dominated the American league while the Yankees marched to the 1956 pennant, will accept the most valuable player award at Yankee stadium.

Pirate Fans Go Wild

For the first time in their history, the Pittsburgh Pirates were honored at a welcome-home parade yesterday.

Police estimated 25,000 persons lined the route where the Pirates were greeted like conquering heroes. No one, or at least not many persons, mentioned that the Pirates finished seventh in the National league last season . . .

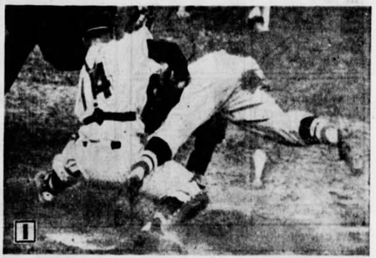
Cleveland sold outfielder Dave Pope to its San Diego farm club and optioned pitchers Hank Aguirre and Bud Daley to the Padres.

Boston Stars Out

Boston lost Jackie Jensen, Billy Goodman and Mel Parnell for its opening game at Baltimore.

Jansen remained in Boston to undergo a series of tests for an ailing back. Goodman's father died Sunday. Parnell, the only veteran lefthanded pitcher on the staff, has been put on the disabled list because his arm refused to re-

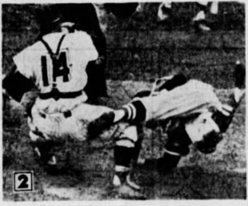
Majors
Continued on page 18



1

AN ORIOLE GOES FLYING

CLINT COURTNEY, No. 14, Washington Senators' catcher, prevents Al Pilarcik of the Baltimore Orioles from scoring the potential winning run in the ninth inning Monday in the season's opening game at Washington. As Pilarcik comes sliding home (Picture No. 1), Courtney lifts his leg and sends him sprawling as he puts the ball on him for the out (pictures No. 2). Both players tumble earthword. Baltimore won the major league opener 7-6 in 11 innings.—(AP Wirephoto.)



2

Kalmikoffs, Brunettis — At It Again

Ivan and Karol Kalmikoff wrestle the Brunetti brothers, Joe and Guy, for the fourth time tonight in a two-of-three fall bout in the Minneapolis auditorium.

The Brunettis won the first three bouts.

Featuring the three 30-minute one fall supporting part of the program will be the first Minneapolis appearance of the Cough drop kids, Al and John Smith. Al meets Danno Geohagen of Ireland while John takes on talented Johnny Rougeau, the French Canadian titleholder.

Clyde Steeves, another newcomer, and Rock Monroe open the show.

■

DUCKS UNLIMITED ELECTS DOW

CLEVELAND, Ohio —(UP)—Jack Dow, Minneapolis, was elected to the board of trustees of Ducks Unlimited, Inc., at the board's 20th meeting here.

STANDINGS

AMERICAN LEAGUE

	W	L	Pct.	GB
Baltimore	1	0	1.000	...
Boston	0	0	.000	½
Detroit	0	0	.000	½
Chicago	0	0	.000	½
Cleveland	0	0	.000	½
Kansas City	0	0	.000	½
New York	0	0	.000	½
Washington	0	1	.000	1

RESULTS MONDAY
Baltimore 7, Washington 6, 11 innings. Only game scheduled.

GAMES TODAY
Washington (Stobbs 15-15) at New York (Ford 19-6) (30,000).
Detroit (Lary 21-13) at Kansas City (Morgan 6-7) (31,000).
Chicago (Pierce 20-9) at Cleveland (Score 20-9) (35,000).
Boston (Brewer 19-9) at Baltimore (Wight 9-12) (35,000).

NATIONAL LEAGUE

RESULTS MONDAY
No games scheduled.

GAMES TODAY
Brooklyn (Newcombe 27-7) at Philadelphia (Roberts 19-18), night (25,000).
Milwaukee (Spahn 20-11) at Chicago (Rush 13-10) (35,000).
St. Louis (Wehmeier 12-11) at Cincinnati (Klippstein 12-11) (33,000).
New York (Antonelli 20-13) at Pittsburgh (Friend 17-17) (36,000).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION

GAMES TODAY
Minneapolis at Indianapolis.
Denver at Louisville.
Omaha at Charleston.
St. Paul at Wichita.

Montreal Returns Home for Cup Clash

From the Tribune Wire Services

Coach Toe Blake brought his disappointed Montreal hockey team home Monday for its Stanley Cup game tonight with Boston.

"Our power play was lousy at Boston," Blake said, referring to Boston's 2-0 victory which still left Montreal with a 3-1 edge in the best-of-seven series . . .

Bill Rohr, Northwestern's new basketball coach, said he planned intensified recruiting in Ohio and Illinois. "I know the Ohio territory very well," Rohr said, "and I'll get to know the boys in Illinois."

In boxing, Sugar Ray Robinson is serious over his title bout with Gene Fullmer. "I'm not champion any more," he said, "and I'd sure like to be" . . . Another former middleweight champ, Jake LaMotta, lost his bid for a new trial on charges of leading a 14-year-old girl into prostitution . . .

Hannum Gets Pact

Alex Hannum was offered a permanent contract as coach of the St. Louis Hawks by owner Ben Kerner . . .

The smaller British ball may keep Doug Ford from entering the British Open golf tournament. Ford doesn't want to miss tournament play at home for such an extended period.

Writers Pick Millers Fourth, Denver First

The consensus poll of American Association baseball writers consigns Minneapolis to fourth place and Denver to the pennant.

The Bears, who finished second to Indianapolis last year after leading until mid-August, drew nine first-place votes and amassed a total of 131 points.

The Millers, fourth a year ago, picked up two first-place ballots and five for second. Wichita and Omaha finished 2-3 in the poll with 113 and 105 points to Minneapolis' 99.

Running down the list, St. Paul ranks fifth, Charleston sixth, Indianapolis seventh and Louisville eighth.

The 1957 vote:

Club	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	Points*
Denver	9	4	3	1	2	0	0	0	131
Wichita	2	6	5	2	3	1	0	0	113
Omaha	3	3	4	4	1	4	0	0	105
Minneapolis	2	5	2	3	1	5	1	0	99
St. Paul	3	0	3	4	5	4	0	0	94
Charleston	0	1	2	5	6	4	1	0	82
Indianapolis	0	0	0	0	1	0	15	3	37
Louisville	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	16	23

*Points are computed on the basis of allowing eight points for first place votes, seven for second place, six for third place, etc.

OPEN MONDAY AND THURSDAY EVENINGS
the NEW NEW HAVEN'S
New Location — 1112 NICOLLET
Just Across the Street
NEW HAVEN
Men's Shop, Inc.
1112 NICOLLET AVE. FE. 2-8805
One hour FREE Customer Parking—12th & LaSalle

Copyright © 2025 Newspapers.com. All Rights Reserved.